Research Plan

PS50008A Research Methods | Term 2 Spring 2026

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12 January 2026

Key Information

Deadline	Friday 27 February 2026, 12 noon
Submission	Via Moodle submission link
Word count	Approximately 1,000 words
Weight	20%

Task

Describe how you would investigate **ONE** of the following research topics: (Examples only)

1. **The effect of caffeine on learning nouns.**
2. **The effect of TV programme content on the recall of advertisements presented part-way through the programme.**
3. **The effect of relaxation classes on stress reduction in the work place.**

What to Include

a) Experimental Hypothesis

- State your experimental hypothesis clearly
- Note whether it is one-tailed or two-tailed
- Explain why you chose this direction

b) Method Section

A detailed Method section with:

- **Design**: What type of design? Why is it appropriate?
- **Participants**: Who, how many, how recruited?

- **Materials/Stimuli**: What materials would you need?
- **Procedure**: Step by step, with controls

c) Draft Results Section

- Draw a summary data table (with appropriate headings—do NOT invent data)
- State which statistical test should be used
- Justify your choice of test

Important Notes

> ⚠️ Do NOT Invent Data
>
> This is a **plan**, not a completed study. Focus on justifying your choices throughout and show you understand the connection between design and analysis.

Connection to Group Project

The Research Plan assessment is based on your group's research question. While you develop your research question as a group, the Research Plan submission is **individual**.

Timeline

Week	Milestone
11	Form groups (3-4 students)
12-15	Develop research question and design
—	*Reading Week* — Work on Research Plan
16	**Research Plan due** Friday 27 Feb

Assessment Criteria

Your Research Plan will be assessed on:

- Clarity and appropriateness of hypothesis
- Justification of design choices
- Feasibility and detail of procedure
- Appropriate selection and justification of statistical test
- Overall coherence and scientific reasoning